# Complaints Handling Procedure

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| **Reference** | COM-PLN-03 v2 |
| **Owner** | Patient Experience Team |
| **Approved by** | Quality and Patient Safety Committee |
| **Effective date** | 09/02/2026 |
| **Next review** | 09/02/2029 |
| **Applies to** | All clinical areas of the Centre Hospitalier Saint-Aubin |

## 1. Overview

This document describes the arrangements in force at the Centre Hospitalier Saint-Aubin for the topic named in its title. It does not contain clinical dosing, results or patient-specific information. Staff are asked to consult the relevant clinical protocols for patient care decisions.

## 2. Arrangements

Responsibilities are shared between the department concerned, the ward managers and the directorate. Operational details are held by the document owner.

## 3. Governance, audit and training

This document is controlled. Printed copies are uncontrolled: the current version is held on the hospital document management system and a printed copy must be checked against it before use.

The document owner reviews the content at least every three years or earlier when national guidance, a serious incident or an audit finding requires it. Interim changes are approved by the relevant committee chair and recorded in the revision history.

Compliance is audited by the clinical audit department on a rolling sample of records. Results are reported to the quality and patient safety committee, which agrees actions with the ward managers and monitors their completion.

Staff who identify a deviation from this document, or a situation it does not cover, should discuss it with the senior clinician on duty and report it through the incident reporting system. Reporting is a learning tool and not a disciplinary process.

## 4. Revision history

| Version | Date | Author | Summary of change |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1.0 | 09/02/2021 | Patient Experience Team | First issue |
| 2.0 | 09/02/2023 | Patient Experience Team | Triennial review; format harmonised |
| 3.0 | 09/06/2025 | Patient Experience Team | Tables updated after clinical audit |
| current | 09/02/2026 | Patient Experience Team | Review and re-issue |

## Annex A. Implementation notes

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Training on this document is part of the induction programme for clinical staff and is refreshed through the annual mandatory training cycle. Agency and locum staff receive a short briefing at the start of their first shift.

Where this document refers to a role (for example the ward pharmacist or the senior nurse), the post-holder on duty carries out the task or delegates it to a suitably trained colleague who remains accountable to them.

Equality and diversity: this document has been assessed for its effect on patients and staff with protected characteristics. Reasonable adjustments, interpreters and accessible formats are available through the patient experience team.

Data protection: any patient information handled under this document is processed in accordance with the data protection policy of the hospital. Access to records is limited to staff involved in the care of the patient.

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